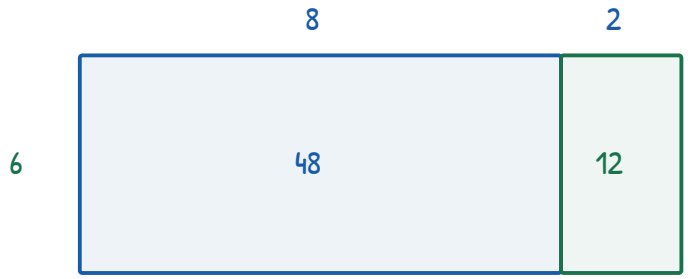
The distributive property shows equal parts

I can... explain a multiplication expression by decomposing a factor.



$6 \times (8 + 2) = 6 \times 10 = 60$

The area model has 48 squares in one part and 12 in the other.

$48 + 12 = 60$

The model explains why the two parts equal the whole product.